

Cabrini Connections (CC) Management Information/Learning System "MILS"

Variables for Data Collection, Summary and Analysis

This document is the first draft of the design of MILS. Here I describe:

1. Programs that we manage
2. Components managed within each program
3. Variables that describe each component (that is, the things that we manage within in each component)
4. Data that will be collected for each variable (in order to understand, predict, and control/manage how that variable works)
5. Examples of summaries/queries and analyses using these data

MILS will use both Internet and non-Internet (paper, computer-only, photo, chalk or other non-web tools) methods. The purpose of MILS is to balance the production of rich information with information that is easily summarized and leads to valid conclusions.

MY PLAN HERE IS TO SHOW THE EXTENT TO WHICH I DO/DO NOT UNDERSTAND THE CC AND WHAT WE ARE TRYING TO ACCOMPLISH SO WE CAN MAKE SURE WE THEN MEASURE/TRACK WHAT MATTERS FOR ACCOMPLISHING OUR BUSINESS. PLEASE, PLEASE MAKE CORRECTIONS AND ADD TO MY THOUGHTS THROUGHOUT THIS DOCUMENT. - THANKS, STEVE

1 & 2: Programs & Components

At this point, I see CC being made up of 3 "programs" with the following components. By "programs" I mean planned services and/or activities with specific (and usually separate) staff dedicated to them to ensure their implementation. By program "components" I mean the types or groups of activities that (appear to me) are separate. While most of the time activities within each program and its components are separate, they are not mutually exclusive. For example, volunteers and/or their activities in KC could also be involved in/presented at T/MC activities such as the training conference or recruitment fair.

Figure 1

Program 1. Kids' Connection (KC)

P1 Components:

P1A. Kids' Connection Weekly Programs

**P1B. Kids' Connection Periodic
Events/Activities**

P1C. Volunteer & Student Management

Program 2. T/MC

P2 Components:

**P2A. Daily Chicago TM Infrastructure
Development**

P2B. Volunteer Recruitment Campaigns

P2C. Training Conferences

P2D. Program Directory/GIS Mapping

P3E. Website Management

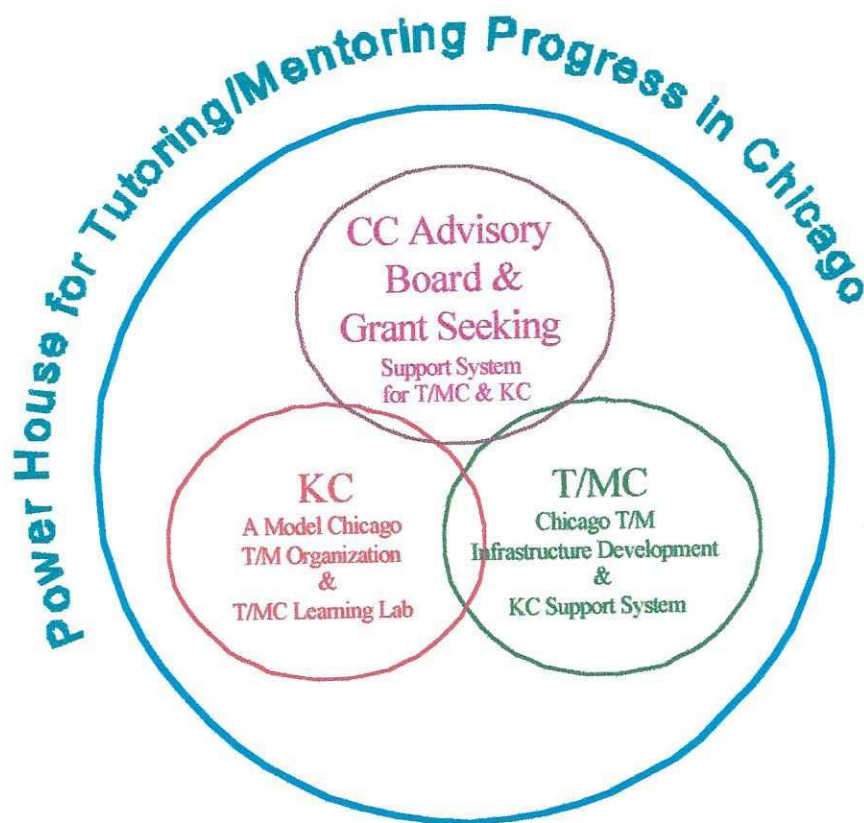
Program 3. CC Advisory Board & Grant Seeking

P3 Components:

These I do not yet understand.

The Venn Diagram in Figure 2 below shows one of ways of describing the relationship between these 3 programs.

Figure 2.



This picture assumes that these 3 CC programs and its components are “aligned” and systematically work together as a “power house” for tutoring/mentoring progress in Chicago (and probably beyond). One of the key purposes of a useful MILS is to assist in this ongoing, dynamic “working together / alignment” process.

The trick to making a useful MILS for us will be to clearly describe what each program and its components do and what that “doing” is intending to produce (the often-called process and outcome variables, though I do not like these terms). This work remains in front of me, rather, of us during the next couple of months. And, this work and consequently MILS will change over time and as we learn to do things better.

3 & 4: Variables & Data

“Variables” are the names we use to describe the actions, things, sometimes people or events in each component that we manage, or work with. The assumption is that we can better manage and work with variables, and hence our programs, if we can understand, predict, and control how they work. To do this we look for signs (information or data) of how they work. The “data” are numerical and non-numerical (yes/no, stories) descriptions of each variable. The prayer of any MILS is that collecting the “right” data in the “right”

manner will provide a "true" picture of how things work and then allow us to better predict and control the success of our business. I use quotes around the terms that involve values, so what is right and true will vary with how we see the world. In our discussions we will try to get to the place where we each of us "sees the world" (as described by our business) in a similar way. Figure 3 is my attempt to describe the variables in the KC and T/MC components based on my understanding to-date.

Figure 3. KC Evaluation Variables

45.	0.	STUDENT TABLE
46.	1.	Student ID: unique ID
47.	2.	Volunteer(s) ID: Volunteer(s) working with student
	--	Links to Volunteer Table
48.	3.	Volunteer/Student relationship(s): 1-to-1, group
49.	4.	School ID: School
	--	Links to School Table
50.	5.	Graduation Date
51.	6.	First Name
52.	7.	Middle Initial
53.	8.	Last Name
54.	9.	Gender
55.	10.	Race/Ethnicity
56.	11.	DOB
57.	12.	Street Address
58.	13.	City
59.	14.	State
60.	15.	Zip Code
61.	16.	Home Phone
62.	17.	Other Phone
63.	18.	Age Group
64.	19.	Grade -- Grade at joining group
65.	20.	Program(s)/Activity(ies) ID: Program/Activities student in
	--	Links to Program/Activity Table
66.	21.	Program Evaluation ID: Skills to Share/Goals
	--	Links to Tables of Student Assessments, Portfolio, and other program evaluation tables
67.	22.	Available Times
68.	23.	Days of week preferred
69.	24.	Hours per week
70.	25.	Date Recruited
71.	26.	Date Ended
72.	27.	Date of Parent Permission
73.	28.	Comments
74.	29.	Commitment Fulfilled
75.	30.	Parent Information
76.	31.	Photo Release (Yes/No)
77.	32.	Disabilities
78.	33.	Allergies
79.	34.	Unique Info
80.	35.	Comments

		PROGRAM/ACTIVITY TABLE
1.	1.	Program/Activity ID -- unique ID
2.	2.	Program Name
3.	3.	Program Time/Duration
4.	4.	Program/Activity Type (1-time, weekly, ongoing, etc.)
5.	5.	Program/Activity Purpose (academic, recreational, etc.)
6.	6.	Location/Location info
7.	7.	Other Descriptors
8.	8.	Program Participation/Timesheets
	--	Links to Timesheets Tables
9.	9.	Program Evaluation
	--	Links to pre/post type, or ongoing data collection tables specific to each program.

		PROGRAM/ACTIVITY TIMESHEET
		(Separate Timesheet per Activity/Program)
1.	1.	Timesheet ID -- unique ID
	--	weekly or daily timesheet each have their own ID
	--	links to other tables
2.	2.	Program/Activity ID -- unique ID
3.	3.	Date(s)
4.	4.	Student ID & Links
5.	5.	Student Participation Info (no show, called, etc.)
6.	6.	Comments re student
7.	7.	Positive Tags Student (1-week perfect attendance, etc)
8.	8.	Volunteer ID & Links
9.	9.	Volunteer Participation Info (no show, called, etc)
10.	10.	Positive Tags Volunteer
11.	11.	Comments re volunteer
12.	12.	Other Timesheet Comments

		VOLUNTEER TABLE
1.	1.	Volunteer ID -- unique ID
2.	2.	First Name
3.	3.	Middle Initial
4.	4.	Last Name
5.	5.	Gender
6.	6.	Race/Ethnicity
7.	7.	Student(s) ID: Student(s) volunteer is working with
	--	Links to Student Table
8.	8.	Date of Application
9.	9.	Date of Interview
10.	10.	Interview/Volunteer Application Data
	--	Links to Volunteer baseline and ongoing evaluation tables
11.	11.	Volunteer Screening Variables (Date of Police Clearance, Date of Child Abuse Clearance, Date Drivers License Clearance
12.	12.	Screening Clearance Status (Pass/Fail)
13.	13.	Date Started
14.	14.	Activity Status (active, in hibernation, terminated)
15.	15.	Why left/terminated/hibernating
16.	16.	Date Terminated
17.	17.	DOB
18.	18.	Street Address
19.	19.	City
20.	20.	State
21.	21.	Zip Code
22.	22.	Don't mail information
23.	23.	Home Phone
24.	24.	Work Phone
25.	25.	Fax
26.	26.	Pager
27.	27.	Email
28.	28.	Other Phone
29.	29.	OK to Call Work Phone?
30.	30.	Emergency Contact
31.	31.	Occupation
32.	32.	Affiliation
33.	33.	Place of Employment
	--	Link to Employer Table
34.	34.	Age Group Preferred
35.	35.	Date of 1 st Training
36.	36.	Program(s)/Activity (ies) ID:
	--	Links to Program/Activity Table
37.	37.	Skills to Share
38.	38.	Available Times
39.	39.	Days of week preferred
40.	40.	How learned about us
41.	41.	Donations
	--	Link to Donors/Sponsor s Table
42.	42.	Unique Info
43.	43.	Comments

		STUDENT/VOLUNTEER SATISFACTION TABLES
		Satisfaction Survey ID - unique ID
		Modeled after current satisfaction forms and can be linked to Student ID
		Volunteer ID
		Program/Activity ID if needed

		PROGRAM/ACTIVITY EVALUATION TABLES
		Program Evaluation ID - unique ID
		Modeled after current program evaluation forms and linked to Student ID
		Volunteer ID
		Program/Activity ID

Figure 3 looks a bit overwhelming to me. It is based on information from what I've seen from you so far and on previous experience with data collection systems of volunteer-based organizations. What am I attempting to communicate?? There are some key types of variables that will have a "unique ID". These variables come with a TABLE with lots of other variables. This means that we can run summaries and analyses based on that unique ID (e.g., a list of volunteers, programs, etc.) and analyses (mailing labels for volunteers, a check of what volunteers are in what programs over time) for a given unique ID variable AND (this is the great part) across variables with unique ID. I'll describe more of this later.

Internet and non-Internet tools with at procedures such as will collect the information in these tables:

1. Daily or weekly timesheets
2. Volunteer interview (baseline) forms
3. Periodic student data collection (e.g., quarterly report-cards, baseline interview survey, student feedback to volunteer forms, portfolio assessment)
4. Periodic volunteer data collection (volunteer outcomes survey, volunteer feedback/performance assessment of students)
5. Annual satisfaction surveys
6. Program/Activity specific surveys (depending on what and how each is "evaluated")

The way we collect the information will be by paper, scantron forms, or via direct data entry on the Internet. The data entry of all collected data will be a combination Internet-based/desktop system. Reports will be generated on paper, desktop, and on the Internet.

We'll discuss what is the best way to track what type of data in our future meetings.

Some examples of summaries/queries and analyses using these data

(THIS WILL BE A BIG PART OF OUR CONVERSATIONS ON "WHAT DO YOU WANT TO KNOW & DO". IF YOU WANT TO KNOW SOMETHING AND WE CANNOT DO AN ANALYSIS ON IT, THEN MILS HAS FAILED.)

- o Number of volunteers, students, and hours served by volunteers listed by activity/month
- o Number of volunteers by employer
- o Number of volunteers continuing from previous years
- o Number of volunteers at each stage of involvement (intake completed, background check completed, training completed, placement made)
- o History of Volunteer Involvement
- o List of volunteers by program and/or activity
- o List Volunteer's by DOB
- o List Volunteer's by zip code
- o Volunteer demographics (average age, gender, race/ethnicity, education levels, skills, etc)
- o General information lists: mailing list/label production

Well, that is as far as I got right now. Part of the T/MC data collection system is shown on the cc_staff egroups Internet site. Variables and data for the volunteer recruitment campaigns, the semi-annual training conferences, and program directory/GIS mapping will come in another draft soon.

I look forward to your feedback, Steve